ISSUE
No
XIII

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

⚡ DIGITAL EDITION · 4 EDITORIALS

TODAY'S EDITORIALS

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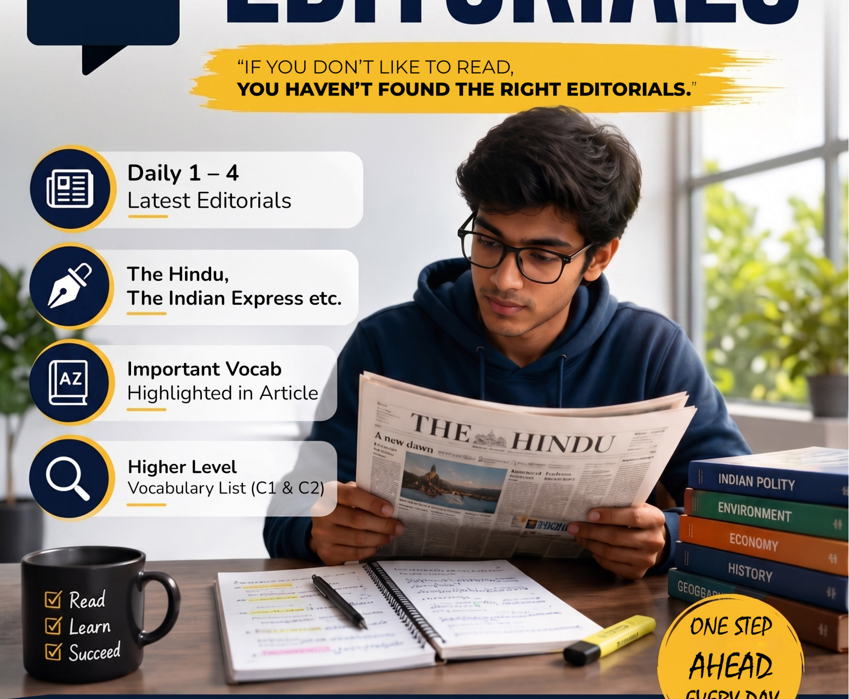

- **Daily 1 – 4**
  Latest Editorials
- **The Hindu,**
  The Indian Express etc.
- **Important Vocab**
  Highlighted in Article
- **Higher Level**
  Vocabulary List (C1 & C2)

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SEPTEMBER 3,2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

01 Orthodoxy redux: On Keralam, religion and Muslim women’s rights
THE HINDU · Gender Rights & Constitutional Law · Page 03

02 Many layers: On onion produce, issues
THE HINDU · Agricultural Economics / Trade Policy · Page 06

03 Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there’s a question
THE INDIAN EXPRESS · Judicial Reform & Civil Liberties · Page 09

04 Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact
THE INDIAN EXPRESS · Inter-State Water Disputes & Environmental Governance · Page 12

05

06

> *No. I can survive well enough on my own— if given the proper reading material.*
>
> *-SARAH J. MAAS*

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THE HINDU

GENDER RIGHTS & CONSTITUTIONAL LAW

Orthodoxy redux: On Keralam, religion and Muslim women's rights

> *Kerala's progressive ethos must firmly resist religious dictates curbing Muslim women's public participation.*

September 3, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Veteran Islamic cleric Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar's directive to restrict Muslim women's participation in public celebrations has **unsettled**[2] Keralam because it **strikes at**[3] a fundamental question: women's right to participate in public life. This is not merely a quarrel over how Muslims should mark Prophet Muhammad's 1,501st birth anniversary. It is a test of how far religious authority can **intrude into**[4] the lives of women in a State that takes pride in its progressive social history. Kanthapuram says he is merely reminding followers of established religious norms. His supporters argue Milad celebrations have moved beyond mosques and madrasas into large public events, and that scholars have a duty to caution against such **departures**[5]. That argument **holds no weight**[6]. Communities have the right to preserve traditions and regulate religious practices, but they have to **conform to**[7] the values **enshrined in**[8] the Constitution. When women are told to remain at home because their presence could cause "chaos", the issue is no longer about religious observance; it is **at variance with**[9] constitutional equality and Keralam's long struggle to expand the space in public life for women **disadvantaged**[10] by social customs and religious traditions.

The Muslim community is not a **monolith**[11]. It contains both orthodox and progressive currents. More Muslim women are breaking barriers in education, employment, politics and public life, but that progress is encountering a **counter-current**[12] of renewed orthodoxy and social control. The CPI(M), Keralam's main Opposition party and a decades-old ally of the Kanthapuram-led faction of Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama, a body of Sunni scholars, has responded sharply. The Congress, which leads the ruling coalition, was largely **guarded**[13] until Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan **rubbished**[14] the **decree**[15] as **antediluvian**[16]. The Indian Union Muslim League's silence is harder to defend. A party with an active women's forum and a woman legislator for the first time in the State Assembly cannot **equivocate**[17] when women's right to public participation is **open to challenge**[18]. Its caution may reflect political pressure over Waqf, Vande Mataram and PM-SHRI, or an attempt to improve ties with the Kanthapuram faction amid strained relations with the rival Samastha faction. Whatever the political calculation, silence carries a cost. Religious freedom does not **confer on**[19] religious authorities the right to regulate women's freedom of movement, association and degree of participation in society. During Onam, social media were **awash with**[20] videos of young Muslim girls celebrating the harvest festival. Kanthapuram's remarks drew criticism from a section of Muslim women on social media. Keralam cannot claim to be progressive while **making exceptions for**[21] orthodoxy.

Source: The Hindu

Published: September 03, 2026 12:20 AM IST

VOCABULARY 101

1. **Redux** (Adjective)
   revived • पुनरुत्थान या वापसी
2. **Unsettled** (Verb)
   disturbed • अशांत कर दिया
3. **Strikes at** (Verb)
   attacks • पर गहरा प्रहार करना
4. **Intrude into** (Verb)
   interfere in • अनाधिकार हस्तक्षेप करना
5. **Departures** (Noun)
   deviations • परंपरा या नियम से भटकाव
6. **Holds no weight** (Phrase)
   lacks validity • तर्कहीन या महत्वहीन होना
7. **Conform to** (Verb)
   follow • के अनुसार होना या पालन करना
8. **Enshrined in** (Verb)
   protected in • पवित्र रूप से स्थापित या संरक्षित
9. **At variance with** (Phrase)
   in conflict with • के विपरीत या असंगत
10. **Disadvantaged** (Adjective)
    underprivileged • वंचित या पिछड़ा हुआ
11. **Monolith** (Noun)
    single entity • एकसमान या अविभाज्य समूह
12. **Counter-current** (Noun)
    opposing trend • विपरीत धारा
13. **Guarded** (Adjective)
    cautious • सतर्क या संकोची
14. **Rubbished** (Verb)
    rejected strongly • पूरी तरह खारिज करना या बकवास बताना
15. **Decree** (Noun)
    official order • आधिकारिक या धार्मिक फरमान
16. **Antediluvian** (Adjective)
    primitive • अति प्राचीन या अत्यंत दकियानूसी
17. **Equivocate** (Verb)
    dodge the truth • गोलमोल बात करना या टालमटोल करना
18. **Open to challenge** (Phrase)
    vulnerable to dispute • विवाद या चुनौती के लिए खुला होना
19. **Confer on** (Verb)
    grant to • प्रदान करना या सौंपना
20. **Awash with** (Adjective)
    full of • से सराबोर या भरा हुआ
21. **Making exceptions for** (Phrase)
    exempting • के लिए विशेष छूट देना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Orthodoxy redux: On Keralam, religion and Muslim women's rights

THE HINDU

GENDER RIGHTS & CONSTITUTIONAL LAW

EDITORIAL STANCE

DISAPPROVING

"strongly objecting to orthodoxy"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author takes a firm stance against regressive clerical directives aimed at curtailing Muslim women's presence in public spaces. By invoking constitutional principles and Kerala's reformist heritage, the editorial condemns political equivocation and asserts that religious autonomy cannot override fundamental gender equality.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

8 WORDS

01	**Unsettled** VERB NEGATIVE	अशांत कर दिया Caused someone or a society to feel anxious, disturbed, or unstable.	**MEMORY HOOK** Un + settled: losing one's settled peace of mind or calm stability.	**SYNONYMS** • disconcerted • perturbed • agitated	**ANTONYMS** • composed • reassured • pacified
02	**Departures** NOUN NEUTRAL	परंपरा या नियम से भटकाव Divergences or variations from established rules, customs, or accepted norms.	**MEMORY HOOK** When a train departs, it leaves the platform; when an action is a departure, it leaves standard custom.	**SYNONYMS** • deviations • divergences • aberrations	**ANTONYMS** • conformities • adherences • continuations
03	**Disadvantaged** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	वंचित या पिछड़ा हुआ Placed in an unfavourable or deprived position regarding social rights and opportunities.	**MEMORY HOOK** Dis (not) + advantaged: denied the basic opportunities and benefits enjoyed by others.	**SYNONYMS** • marginalised • deprived • underprivileged	**ANTONYMS** • privileged • advantaged • empowered
04	**Counter-current** NOUN NEGATIVE	विपरीत धारा A trend or tendency running contrary to the predominant movement or prevailing progress.	**MEMORY HOOK** A current flowing in the counter (opposite) direction against the main tide.	**SYNONYMS** • backlash • counteraction • reversal	**ANTONYMS** • mainstream • momentum • concurrence
05	**Guarded** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	सतर्क या संकोची Careful, restrained, and unwilling to reveal true opinions or commit firmly.	**MEMORY HOOK** Keeping your guard up so you don't reveal too much or make commitments.	**SYNONYMS** • circumspect • non-committal • reticent	**ANTONYMS** • forthright • candid • unreserved
06	**Rubbished** VERB NEGATIVE	पूरी तरह खारिज करना या बकवास बताना Criticised, ridiculed, or rejected an idea as completely absurd or worthless.	**MEMORY HOOK** Treating someone's idea like 'rubbish' (trash) by throwing it out with contempt.	**SYNONYMS** • dismissed • derided • repudiated	**ANTONYMS** • endorsed • lauded • validated
07	**Decree** NOUN NEUTRAL	आधिकारिक या धार्मिक फरमान An authoritative order, dictate, or edict having the binding force of law or religious mandate.	**MEMORY HOOK** Decree rhymes with 'agree'; a command that everyone is ordered to agree with.	**SYNONYMS** • edict • dictate • pronouncement	**ANTONYMS** • recommendation • suggestion • petition
08	**Equivocate** VERB NEGATIVE	गोलमोल बात करना या टालमटोल करना To use ambiguous language to conceal the truth or avoid committing oneself to a clear position.	**MEMORY HOOK** Equi (equal) + vocal (voice): speaking with two equal voices to confuse the listener.	**SYNONYMS** • prevaricate • temporise • vacillate	**ANTONYMS** • clarify • speak frankly • declare openly

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · ORTHODOXY REDUX: ON KERALAM, RELIGION AND MUSLIM WOMEN'S RIGHTS

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

2 TERMS

01	**Monolith** NOUN NEUTRAL	एकसमान या अविभाज्य समूह A large, uniform, and indivisible organisation or community that lacks internal diversity.	**MEMORY HOOK** Mono (single) + lith (stone): a single giant stone, metaphorically meaning a uniform, indivisible body.	**SYNONYMS** • uniform whole • homogeneous mass • indivisible entity	**ANTONYMS** • heterogeneous group • plurality • mosaic
02	**Antediluvian** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अति प्राचीन या अत्यंत दकियानूसी Extremely old-fashioned, archaic, or ridiculously out of date.	**MEMORY HOOK** Ante (before) + deluge (the biblical flood): so extremely old that it belongs before Noah's flood.	**SYNONYMS** • archaic • outmoded • antiquated	**ANTONYMS** • modern • progressive • contemporary

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

5 TERMS

01	**Intrude into** VERB NEGATIVE	**अनाधिकार हस्तक्षेप करना** To enter or force oneself into a private sphere where one is not welcomed or entitled to be.	**MEMORY HOOK** Intruders enter private spaces without permission; hence 'intrude into' means encroaching unlawfully.	**SYNONYMS** • encroach on • trespass upon • infringe upon	**ANTONYMS** • withdraw from • disregard • leave alone
02	**Conform to** VERB NEUTRAL	**के अनुसार होना या पालन करना** To comply with rules, standards, laws, or accepted customs.	**MEMORY HOOK** Conform = comply with the form/standard set by rules.	**SYNONYMS** • adhere to • abide by • align with	**ANTONYMS** • deviate from • violate • flout
03	**Enshrined in** VERB POSITIVE	**पवित्र रूप से स्थापित या संरक्षित** Preserved, protected, and expressed formally as a cherished right or principle.	**MEMORY HOOK** Placing something in a 'shrine' preserves it with utmost reverence and permanence.	**SYNONYMS** • embodied in • entrenched in • safeguarded in	**ANTONYMS** • excised from • erased from • omitted from
04	**Confer on** VERB NEUTRAL	**प्रदान करना या सौंपना** To grant or bestow a title, right, privilege, or power upon someone.	**MEMORY HOOK** Confer is to offer a right or title upon someone with authority.	**SYNONYMS** • bestow upon • accord to • grant to	**ANTONYMS** • divest of • withhold from • strip from
05	**Awash with** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	**से सराबोर या भरा हुआ** Containing large numbers or quantities of something; completely inundated or flooded.	**MEMORY HOOK** Awash implies being submerged under high waves of water or content.	**SYNONYMS** • inundated with • replete with • overflowing with	**ANTONYMS** • devoid of • deficient in • lacking in

PHRASAL VERBS

1 TERMS

01	**Strikes at** VERB NEGATIVE	**पर गहरा प्रहार करना** Directly threatens, challenges, or affects the essential foundation of something.	**MEMORY HOOK** When you strike at the core, you hit the most essential foundation directly.	**SYNONYMS** • undermines • assails • threatens	**ANTONYMS** • fortifies • upholds • sustains

IDIOMS & PHRASES

4 TERMS

01	**Holds no weight** PHRASE NEGATIVE	**तर्कहीन या महत्वहीन होना** Lacks convincing force, credibility, or logical significance.	**MEMORY HOOK** An argument with zero weight will simply blow away because it has no substance.	**SYNONYMS** • carries no conviction • lacks merit • falls flat	**ANTONYMS** • holds water • carries weight • remains valid
02	**At variance with** PHRASE NEGATIVE	**के विपरीत या असंगत** In direct contradiction, disagreement, or conflict with something else.	**MEMORY HOOK** Variance means variation or dispute; if you are 'at variance', you vary completely from the norm.	**SYNONYMS** • incompatible with • contrary to • inconsistent with	**ANTONYMS** • in harmony with • consistent with • in accord with
03	**Open to challenge** PHRASE NEGATIVE	**विवाद या चुनौती के लिए खुला होना** Vulnerable to questioning, opposition, or legal and social contestation.	**MEMORY HOOK** If a gate is left 'open', anyone can step up and challenge whatever is inside.	**SYNONYMS** • disputable • contestable • vulnerable	**ANTONYMS** • indisputable • unassailable • incontestable
04	**Making exceptions for** PHRASE NEGATIVE	**के लिए विशेष छूट देना** Allowing a particular person, group, or ideology to be exempt from general rules or progressive standards.	**MEMORY HOOK** Carving out an 'exception' lets someone bypass the standard rule that applies to all.	**SYNONYMS** • granting exemptions to • tolerating • indulging	**ANTONYMS** • applying universally to • enforcing strictly against • disallowing

FOREIGN WORDS

1 TERMS

01	**Redux** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	**पुनरुत्थान या वापसी** Brought back, revived, or restored, especially an idea or condition from the past.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 're-do'; think of something brought back or repeated again.	**SYNONYMS** • resurgent • revisited • returned	**ANTONYMS** • extinct • vanished • obsolete

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 06
Many layers: On onion produce, issues

Many layers: On onion produce, issues

> *Reactive market interventions fail to resolve structural flaws in India's agricultural supply chain.*

September 3, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Since the 1960s, India has developed a **balancing-act**[1] habit: between keeping food prices affordably low for consumers and assuring farmers of **remunerative**[2] prices, with the state's interventions focused on managing this **volatility**[3] in the short term. This is also why the government banned onion exports from December 2023 to May 2024, then imposed a $550/tonne minimum export price and a 40% export duty, reduced the duty to 20% in September 2024, and finally abolished it in April 2025. But **erratic**[4] weather together with the lack of long-term relief has **rendered**[5] the act increasingly awkward. From farmers' point of view, the government often changes its mind after they have made important production-related decisions based on the expected price. On the other hand, during the **bounteous**[6] rabi harvest, onion farmers in Maharashtra, the country's principal supplier, had argued that the Centre's **procurement**[7] price of ₹12.35/kg would not cover the costs of cultivation. The Centre **subsequently**[8] raised the price to up to ₹26.45/kg, but many farmers — including some who had had to sell at ₹1/kg earlier because of low quality and lack of storage, among other factors — were unable to capture the higher value, exposing the limits of intervening after prices have already collapsed and not reaching all farmers or grades of produce.

While the government has **alluded to**[9] some price **manipulation**[10], the **dominant**[11] issue remains that it keeps reacting instead of taking **proactive**[12] measures, including improving storage options, maintaining a less **erratic**[4] trade policy, moving stock more efficiently between regions, and protecting farmers against price shocks. The abnormal rainfall at the time of harvest and a 5%-7% drop in the kharif crop in Maharashtra, together with the well-known challenges associated with storing onions and maintaining large **buffers**[13], are simply among the pressures that **highlighted**[14] the flaw this year. Further, Tamil Nadu's targeted subsidy, to buy 1,000 tonnes of onions to distribute 1 kg per ration card at ₹35, will impose pressures on the Centre to maintain a steady supply. The move is **commendably**[15] designed to discourage **hoarding**[16] while allowing private retail prices to **cool down**[17]. However, the State must also **guard against**[18] the **pitfalls**[19] of distributing onions through a dry-grain PDS network — its economic case could collapse if post-harvest losses, to which onion is more **susceptible to**[20] than, say, wheat or rice, exceed 10%-15% — and if the need arises to **persist with**[21] the subsidy. Finally, if other States also adopt similar measures, the Central buffer could be quickly **exhausted**[22], more so given this year's high storage losses of around 30%.

Source: **The Hindu**

Published: **September 03, 2026 12:10 AM IST**

VOCABULARY 101

1	**balancing-act**	(Noun)	compromise	संतुलन बनाए रखने का प्रयास
2	**remunerative**	(Adjective)	profitable	लाभकारी / फलप्रद
3	**volatility**	(Noun)	instability	अस्थिरता
4	**erratic**	(Adjective)	unpredictable	अनियमित / डांवाडोल
5	**rendered**	(Verb)	made	बना दिया / कर दिया
6	**bounteous**	(Adjective)	abundant	प्रचुर / भरपूर
7	**procurement**	(Noun)	purchasing	खरीद / अधिप्राप्ति
8	**subsequently**	(Adverb)	afterwards	बाद में / तत्पश्चात
9	**alluded to**	(Verb)	hinted at	का संकेत देना
10	**manipulation**	(Noun)	rigging	हेरफेर / जोड़-तोड़
11	**dominant**	(Adjective)	primary	प्रमुख / मुख्य
12	**proactive**	(Adjective)	forward-thinking	सक्रिय / अग्रसक्रिय
13	**buffers**	(Noun)	reserves	सुरक्षित भंडार / बफर स्टॉक
14	**highlighted**	(Verb)	emphasised	उजागर किया / प्रमुखता दी
15	**commendably**	(Adverb)	praiseworthily	सराहनीय रूप से
16	**hoarding**	(Noun)	stockpiling	जमाखोरी
17	**cool down**	(Verb)	moderate	शांत या स्थिर होना
18	**guard against**	(Verb)	prevent	से बचाव करना / सावधानी बरतना
19	**pitfalls**	(Noun)	hazards	छिपे हुए खतरे / कमियां
20	**susceptible to**	(Adjective)	vulnerable to	के प्रति संवेदनशील / अतिसंवेदनशील
21	**persist with**	(Verb)	continue	जारी रखना / लगे रहना
22	**exhausted**	(Verb)	depleted	समाप्त / खत्म हो जाना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Many layers: On onion produce, issues

THE HINDU

AGRICULTURAL ECONOMICS / TRADE POLICY

EDITORIAL STANCE

CRITICAL

"fault-finding and analytical"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author evaluates India's agricultural trade interventions, arguing that knee-jerk policy shifts fail both farmers and consumers. By highlighting erratic export duties, inadequate storage infrastructure, and recurring price shocks, the text underscores the limits of reactive governance. The author advocates for proactive, structural reforms over temporary subsidies to achieve long-term market stability.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

14 WORDS

01	**remunerative** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	लाभकारी / फलप्रद Earning or paying a substantial amount of profit or financial reward.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sound like 're-money-rative' — getting good money/profit in return for work.	**SYNONYMS** • lucrative • profitable • gainful	**ANTONYMS** • unremunerative • unprofitable • loss-making
02	**volatility** NOUN NEGATIVE	अस्थिरता The quality of changing rapidly and unpredictably, especially for the worse.	**MEMORY HOOK** Volatile chemicals evaporate quickly and unpredictably, just like unstable prices.	**SYNONYMS** • instability • unpredictability • fluctuation	**ANTONYMS** • stability • steadiness • constancy
03	**erratic** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनियमित / डांवाडोल Not regular or consistent in pattern, movement, or behaviour.	**MEMORY HOOK** Contains 'error' — an erratic pattern makes frequent errors in predictability.	**SYNONYMS** • unpredictable • inconsistent • fitful	**ANTONYMS** • consistent • regular • steady
04	**rendered** VERB NEUTRAL	बना दिया / कर दिया Caused someone or something to be in a particular state or condition.	**MEMORY HOOK** Render sounds like 'surrender' — making someone or something into a particular state.	**SYNONYMS** • made • caused to be • turned	**ANTONYMS** • kept • maintained • preserved
05	**bounteous** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	प्रचुर / भरपूर Generously given or existing in large, plentiful quantities.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think of a 'bounty' or reward that is overflowing and plentiful.	**SYNONYMS** • plentiful • abundant • copious	**ANTONYMS** • meagre • scarce • sparse
06	**subsequently** ADVERB NEUTRAL	बाद में / तत्पश्चात At a later time or after a particular event has taken place.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sequential means in order; 'sub-sequently' refers to the step that follows next.	**SYNONYMS** • afterwards • later • thereafter	**ANTONYMS** • previously • prior • beforehand
07	**manipulation** NOUN NEGATIVE	हेरफेर / जोड़-तोड़ Unfair or fraudulent management and alteration of market conditions to one's advantage.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Manipulate' comes from Latin 'manus' (hand) — artificially handling or tampering with outcomes.	**SYNONYMS** • rigging • tampering • exploitation	**ANTONYMS** • fairness • honesty • transparency
08	**dominant** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	प्रमुख / मुख्य Most important, influential, or prominent compared to others.	**MEMORY HOOK** A dominant force dominates everything else because it is the most prominent.	**SYNONYMS** • primary • principal • predominant	**ANTONYMS** • minor • secondary • subordinate
09	**proactive** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	सक्रिय / अग्रसक्रिय Controlling a situation by creating change rather than merely reacting after it happens.	**MEMORY HOOK** 'Pro' means forward — acting beforehand rather than simply reacting after damage occurs.	**SYNONYMS** • enterprising • preventative • forward-looking	**ANTONYMS** • reactive • passive • sluggish
10	**buffers** NOUN NEUTRAL	सुरक्षित भंडार / बफर स्टॉक Extra supplies of commodities kept in reserve to lessen the impact of future shortages.	**MEMORY HOOK** A buffer cushion absorbs a shock; buffer stock protects against sudden supply shortages.	**SYNONYMS** • reserves • cushions • stockpiles	**ANTONYMS** • deficits • shortages • depletions
11	**highlighted** VERB NEUTRAL	उजागर किया / प्रमुखता दी Drew particular attention to an issue or made something prominent.	**MEMORY HOOK** Using a yellow highlighter pen to make text stand out clearly.	**SYNONYMS** • emphasised • accentuated • underlined	**ANTONYMS** • obscured • downplayed • masked
12	**commendably** ADVERB POSITIVE	सराहनीय रूप से In a manner that deserves praise, approval, or admiration.	**MEMORY HOOK** Connect with 'commend' or 'recommend' — worthy of strong praise and approval.	**SYNONYMS** • laudably • praiseworthily • admirably	**ANTONYMS** • reprehensibly • blameworthily • poorly

13	**pitfalls** NOUN NEGATIVE	छिपे हुए खतरे / कमियां Hidden or unsuspected dangers, difficulties, or traps in a plan.	**MEMORY HOOK** A hidden pit into which you fall unexpectedly represents a hidden hazard.	SYNONYMS • hazards • drawbacks • perils	ANTONYMS • advantages • safeguards • benefits
14	**exhausted** VERB NEGATIVE	समाप्त / खत्म हो जाना Used up completely until nothing remains in reserve.	**MEMORY HOOK** Like a car exhaust emitting until all fuel is completely drained out.	SYNONYMS • depleted • drained • spent	ANTONYMS • replenished • restocked • renewed

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · MANY LAYERS: ON ONION PRODUCE, ISSUES

PART 02

📝 ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

2 TERMS

01	**procurement** NOUN NEUTRAL	खरीद / अधिप्राप्ति The official act of obtaining or buying goods and services, especially for public use.	**MEMORY HOOK** To 'cure' a need for goods, an organisation goes through a pro-cure-ment process.	SYNONYMS • acquisition • purchasing • sourcing	ANTONYMS • disposal • sale • distribution
02	**hoarding** NOUN NEGATIVE	जमाखोरी The practice of collecting and storing large quantities of goods to create artificial scarcity.	**MEMORY HOOK** A 'hoard' is an excessive secret pile kept hidden to drive prices up.	SYNONYMS • stockpiling • accumulating • cornering	ANTONYMS • distributing • dispersing • releasing

🔗 FIXED PREPOSITIONS

2 TERMS

01	**susceptible to** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	के प्रति संवेदनशील / अतिसंवेदनशील Likely to be influenced, harmed, or damaged by a particular factor.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'suspect able' — an entity easily suspected of catching harm.	SYNONYMS • vulnerable to • prone to • predisposed to	ANTONYMS • immune to • resistant to • invulnerable to
02	**persist with** VERB NEUTRAL	जारी रखना / लगे रहना To continue doing something or using a method despite difficulties or objections.	**MEMORY HOOK** To persist is to stay 'per-manent' with a task despite obstacles.	SYNONYMS • continue with • persevere in • carry on with	ANTONYMS • abandon • discontinue • relinquish

⚡ PHRASAL VERBS

3 TERMS

01	**alluded to** VERB NEUTRAL	का संकेत देना Referred to something indirectly or mentioned it in a passing manner.	**MEMORY HOOK** Allude = A subtle clue; referring to something without naming it explicitly.	SYNONYMS • hinted at • suggested • implied	ANTONYMS • specified • stated directly • declared
02	**cool down** VERB NEUTRAL	शांत या स्थिर होना To decrease in intensity, speed, or price level after a period of inflation.	**MEMORY HOOK** When heat drops, temperatures cool down; similarly, inflated prices moderate.	SYNONYMS • moderate • subside • abate	ANTONYMS • surge • escalate • heat up
03	**guard against** VERB POSITIVE	से बचाव करना / सावधानी बरतना To take precautions to stop a potential problem or danger from happening.	**MEMORY HOOK** A security guard stands alert to prevent dangerous risks.	SYNONYMS • ward off • shield from • fend off	ANTONYMS • succumb to • invite • overlook

🎭 IDIOMS & PHRASES

1 TERMS

01	**balancing-act** NOUN NEUTRAL	संतुलन बनाए रखने का प्रयास A difficult situation where one tries to satisfy two opposing demands or priorities at the same time.	**MEMORY HOOK** Picture a tightrope walker maintaining balance between two opposite sides.	SYNONYMS • compromise • delicate balance • tightrope walk	ANTONYMS • imbalance • disproportion • bias

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 09
Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there's a question

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

JUDICIAL REFORM & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there's a question

> *Selective relief for student protesters highlights lingering systemic bias against other democratic demonstrations.*

September 3, 2026 · 3 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

All the FIRs … are hereby **quashed**[1]." With that order by a three-judge bench, led by Chief justice of India Surya Kant, a welcome moment of closure was reached on Tuesday. The story began with the students' protests at Jantar Mantar against the NEET paper leak. It saw a **brutish**[2] **crackdown**[3] by the police on the march by mostly young protesters demanding a hearing from the people's representatives in Parliament. These columns have strongly and consistently argued for the freedom to protest peacefully, which is part of the constitutionally guaranteed right to free speech and expression, and against its **criminalisation**[4] by the government. And yet, **rewind to**[5] Tuesday's quashing of FIRs by the Court, **acting on**[6] the request of governments at the Centre and some states, and a question continues to hang in the courtroom: If Tuesday's quashing is an admission that a punishing state unfairly targeted citizens for exercising their democratic right to protest, isn't the manner of the quashing **problematic**[7] — because it seems **selective**[8]? The cases being closed is the right thing to do, but are they being closed for the right reason? Does the government find it **expedient**[9] to close them against one set of protesters while letting those against other protesters **linger on**[10], making the process their punishment? The question is, basically, this: What about the protesters **left out of**[11] Tuesday's frame?

Because the story of the April protests by factory workers in Noida demanding higher wages has **played out**[12] very differently. There, as this paper has reported, a police **crackdown**[3] saw up to 200 people **taken into custody**[13], including two under the **stringent**[14] NSA. The court **stepped in**[15] to grant relief in 84 per cent of the cases — on Wednesday, the Allahabad High Court **quashed**[1] the NSA detention of a student activist, terming the state's case "**concocted**[16]". But they fell one by one, for reasons ranging from lack of specific evidence to treating a crowd as the accused. There was no **blanket**[17] relief — the average period a protester spent in custody was 53 days. Cases related to the 2019-2020 protests against a **discriminatory**[18] citizenship law **unleashed**[19] prolonged legal battles across various courts. In UP, the government continued to harass the accused, **naming and shaming**[20] them in public hoardings, attaching properties by **undue**[21] process, ignoring the court's **rebuke**[22] that it had become both complainant and **adjudicator**[23]. Cases from the farmers' protests of 2021 are still pending. As are those slapped against individuals across the country, for the "crime" of disagreeing with the **powers that be**[24].

Tuesday's quashing of FIRs against students will be a valuable moment if it expands the area of freedom for all — if it means that **henceforth**[25], the government will be more tolerant of free speech and the Court will give the benefit of the doubt to the vulnerable individual, not the government. It will be unfortunate if it only means that the decision to file an FIR and the decision to quash a protest depends on whether the protester is seen as "us" or "them".

Source: The Indian Express
Published: September 03, 2026 06:00 AM IST

VOCABULARY 101

1	**quashed**	(Verb)	cancelled	रद्द कर दिया गया
2	**brutish**	(Adjective)	cruel	बर्बर
3	**crackdown**	(Noun)	suppression	सख्त कार्रवाई
4	**criminalisation**	(Noun)	outlawing	अपराधीकरण
5	**rewind to**	(Verb)	look back at	पीछे मुड़कर देखना
6	**acting on**	(Verb)	following	के अनुसार कार्य करना
7	**problematic**	(Adjective)	questionable	संदिग्ध या समस्याग्रस्त
8	**selective**	(Adjective)	biased	चयनात्मक
9	**expedient**	(Adjective)	convenient	स्वार्थसाधक
10	**linger on**	(Verb)	persist	लंबे समय तक खिंचना
11	**left out of**	(Phrase)	excluded from	वंचित रखा गया
12	**played out**	(Verb)	unfolded	घटित हुआ
13	**taken into custody**	(Phrase)	arrested	हिरासत में लिया गया
14	**stringent**	(Adjective)	strict	कठोर
15	**stepped in**	(Verb)	intervened	हस्तक्षेप किया
16	**concocted**	(Adjective)	fabricated	मनगढ़ंत
17	**blanket**	(Adjective)	total	सार्वत्रिक
18	**discriminatory**	(Adjective)	unfair	भेदभावपूर्ण
19	**unleashed**	(Verb)	released	उन्मुक्त कर दिया
20	**naming and shaming**	(Phrase)	publicly humiliating	सार्वजनिक रूप से बदनाम करना
21	**undue**	(Adjective)	excessive	अनुचित
22	**rebuke**	(Noun)	scolding	फटकार
23	**adjudicator**	(Noun)	judge	निर्णायक
24	**powers that be**	(Phrase)	authorities	सत्तारूढ़ लोग
25	**henceforth**	(Adverb)	from now on	अब से

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there's a question

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

JUDICIAL REFORM & CIVIL LIBERTIES

EDITORIAL STANCE

SCEPTICAL

"questioning government motives"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author critically examines the selective quashing of student FIRs, questioning whether the state's move stems from constitutional principles or political expediency. By contrasting this relief with the persistent penalisation of labour and citizenship protesters, the editorial highlights systemic disparities in how dissent is treated. It urges the judiciary and executive to uphold civil liberties uniformly rather than favouring convenient groups.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

14 WORDS

01	**quashed** VERB POSITIVE	रद्द कर दिया गया Officially annulled, rejected, or declared legally invalid by a court.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'squashed' — imagine a judge crushing or stamping out an unfair legal case.	**SYNONYMS** • annulled • invalidated • overturned	**ANTONYMS** • upheld • validated • enforced
02	**brutish** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	बर्बर Savage, rough, and completely lacking human sensitivity or restraint.	**MEMORY HOOK** Connect with 'brute' — acting like a wild, violent beast without reason or empathy.	**SYNONYMS** • barbaric • ferocious • callous	**ANTONYMS** • gentle • humane • compassionate
03	**crackdown** NOUN NEGATIVE	सख्त कार्रवाई Severe, sudden, and forceful disciplinary measures taken by authorities to restrict activity.	**MEMORY HOOK** When authorities 'crack' the whip down on dissent to suppress it completely.	**SYNONYMS** • suppression • repression • clampdown	**ANTONYMS** • leniency • indulgence • tolerance
04	**problematic** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	संदिग्ध या समस्याग्रस्त Presenting difficulties or doubts that make something open to serious question.	**MEMORY HOOK** Root word 'problem' — something that directly generates doubts or difficulties.	**SYNONYMS** • contentious • dubious • questionable	**ANTONYMS** • unproblematic • straightforward • settled
05	**selective** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	चयनात्मक Affecting or choosing only certain individuals or groups, often unfairly or arbitrarily.	**MEMORY HOOK** Relates to 'select' — choosing only what suits one's own advantage unfairly.	**SYNONYMS** • discriminating • particular • partial	**ANTONYMS** • universal • indiscriminate • uniform
06	**expedient** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	स्वार्थसाधक Convenient and practical for achieving an immediate end, though possibly improper or immoral.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'speedy end' — taking an easy shortcut even if it lacks ethical backing.	**SYNONYMS** • advantageous • pragmatic • opportunistic	**ANTONYMS** • principled • inadvisable • inexpedient
07	**stringent** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	कठोर Extremely strict, binding, or rigorously enforced, leaving little room for compromise.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think of a 'strict string' pulled extremely tight with zero flexibility.	**SYNONYMS** • rigorous • draconian • uncompromising	**ANTONYMS** • lenient • flexible • lax
08	**concocted** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	मनगढ़ंत Invented, fabricated, or made up, usually with the intention to deceive.	**MEMORY HOOK** Like a witch 'concocting' a fake potion in a cauldron—brewing a lie.	**SYNONYMS** • fabricated • invented • contrived	**ANTONYMS** • genuine • authentic • verified
09	**blanket** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	सार्वत्रिक Applying to all conditions, instances, or people universally and without exception.	**MEMORY HOOK** A 'blanket' spreads over everything, covering the whole bed without leaving gaps.	**SYNONYMS** • comprehensive • all-inclusive • sweeping	**ANTONYMS** • specific • conditional • targeted
10	**discriminatory** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	भेदभावपूर्ण Making an unfair, unjust, or prejudicial distinction against individuals or groups.	**MEMORY HOOK** Root word 'discriminate' — showing prejudice against a specific group.	**SYNONYMS** • prejudicial • biased • inequitable	**ANTONYMS** • equitable • impartial • unbiased

11	**unleashed** VERB NEGATIVE	**उन्मुक्त कर दिया** Suddenly released or set loose a powerful, destructive, or uncontrollable force.	**MEMORY HOOK** Un-leash: taking the leash off a wild dog, letting it run wild and cause chaos.	**SYNONYMS** • triggered • vented • precipitated	**ANTONYMS** • restrained • contained • suppressed
12	**undue** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	**अनुचित** Exceeding what is appropriate, warranted, or legally justified.	**MEMORY HOOK** Un + due: not 'due' or appropriate according to standard legal rules.	**SYNONYMS** • unwarranted • excessive • disproportionate	**ANTONYMS** • due • justified • warranted
13	**rebuke** NOUN NEGATIVE	**फटकार** A sharp, stern expression of disapproval or severe criticism.	**MEMORY HOOK** Sounds like 'refuse back' — strongly rejecting someone's behaviour with harsh words.	**SYNONYMS** • reprimand • reproach • censure	**ANTONYMS** • commendation • praise • endorsement
14	**henceforth** ADVERB NEUTRAL	**अब से** From this specific point in time onward.	**MEMORY HOOK** Hence (from here) + forth (forward in time) = from this moment onwards.	**SYNONYMS** • hereafter • from now on • subsequently	**ANTONYMS** • previously • formerly • hitherto

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · THANK YOU FOR QUASHING THE FIRS, BUT THERE'S A QUESTION

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

2 TERMS

01	**criminalisation** NOUN NEGATIVE	**अपराधीकरण** The act of turning an ordinary or lawful activity into an illegal offence punishable by law.	**MEMORY HOOK** Turning regular citizens or lawful actions into 'criminals' by making laws against them.	**SYNONYMS** • proscription • outlawing • penalisation	**ANTONYMS** • decriminalisation • legalisation • legitimisation
02	**adjudicator** NOUN NEUTRAL	**निर्णायक** A person or body that formally reviews evidence to settle a legal or official dispute.	**MEMORY HOOK** Ad-JUDGE-icator: someone whose formal role is to 'judge' a legal dispute.	**SYNONYMS** • arbitrator • judge • umpire	**ANTONYMS** • complainant • litigant • accused

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

1 TERMS

01	**acting on** VERB NEUTRAL	**के अनुसार कार्य करना** Taking decisive action in accordance with specific advice, requests, or information received.	**MEMORY HOOK** You 'act on' instructions when you step forward based on advice or orders.	**SYNONYMS** • executing • implementing • discharging	**ANTONYMS** • disregarding • ignoring • overlooking

PHRASAL VERBS

4 TERMS

01	**rewind to** VERB NEUTRAL	**पीछे मुड़कर देखना** To look back at or return mentally to an earlier event or point in time.	**MEMORY HOOK** Like 'rewinding' a video tape to revisit a previous scene in the past.	**SYNONYMS** • revisit • recall • reconsider	**ANTONYMS** • fast-forward to • advance to • project
02	**linger on** VERB NEGATIVE	**लंबे समय तक खिंचना** To continue to exist or take an unusually long time to finish or disappear.	**MEMORY HOOK** Think of someone who 'lingers' behind after a party, refusing to leave for too long.	**SYNONYMS** • persist • drag on • continue	**ANTONYMS** • conclude • vanish • terminate
03	**played out** VERB NEUTRAL	**घटित हुआ** Developed, unfolded, or occurred in a particular manner over time.	**MEMORY HOOK** Like a theatrical 'play' that performs its script sequentially from start to finish.	**SYNONYMS** • transpired • unfolded • materialised	**ANTONYMS** • halted • stalled • aborted
04	**stepped in** VERB POSITIVE	**हस्तक्षेप किया** Intervened in a difficult or contentious situation to provide assistance or resolve a conflict.	**MEMORY HOOK** Literally 'stepping' into the middle of a conflict to restore order.	**SYNONYMS** • intervened • mediated • interceded	**ANTONYMS** • abstained • withdrew • neglected

IDIOMS & PHRASES

4 TERMS

01	**left out of** PHRASE NEGATIVE	वंचित रखा गया Excluded, omitted, or ignored from a particular group, decision, or benefit.	**MEMORY HOOK** Left standing outside the 'frame' or boundary while others are included inside.	**SYNONYMS** • omitted from • excluded from • marginalised from	**ANTONYMS** • included in • integrated into • admitted to
02	**taken into custody** PHRASE NEGATIVE	हिरासत में लिया गया Formally detained or arrested by law enforcement officers.	**MEMORY HOOK** When authorities take 'custody' (care/control) of a person's freedom by detaining them.	**SYNONYMS** • detained • apprehended • imprisoned	**ANTONYMS** • released • liberated • discharged
03	**naming and shaming** PHRASE NEGATIVE	सार्वजनिक रूप से बदनाम करना Publicly identifying individuals or organisations accused of wrongdoing to cause humiliation.	**MEMORY HOOK** Rhyming phrase: 'name' them openly so that everyone can 'shame' them.	**SYNONYMS** • publicising offences • discrediting • pillorying	**ANTONYMS** • protecting anonymity • shielding • pardoning
04	**powers that be** PHRASE NEUTRAL	सत्तारूढ़ लोग The established authorities, rulers, or decision-makers holding institutional control.	**MEMORY HOOK** Those who possess the executive 'power' that currently 'exists' (is).	**SYNONYMS** • establishment • authorities • rulers	**ANTONYMS** • subordinates • general public • powerless

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 12
Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

INTER-STATE WATER DISPUTES & ENVIRONMENTAL GOVERNANCE

Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact

> *Riparian states must shun confrontation and forge a scientific distress-sharing formula for Cauvery waters.*

September 3, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The opening of the Mettur Dam's **sluice gates**[1] by Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Tuesday will provide some relief to Cauvery Delta farmers. In a normal year, the dam opens on June 12, and its gates are shut on January 28, giving the region's agriculturists a 230-day irrigation window. This schedule is, however, **contingent on**[2] the monsoon and the release of water in the Cauvery's upstream by Karnataka. The Tamil Nadu government has **ascribed**[3] this year's delay to the deficit in the southwest monsoon and Karnataka's failure to honour its water-sharing obligation under the Supreme Court's 2018 verdict. The dispute between the lower and upper **riparian**[4] states **ignited**[5] political tensions in the past three months, and the matter went to the Supreme Court, but the **impasse**[6] wasn't resolved. With the rainfall deficit narrowing in August, the Tamil Nadu government has **leeway**[7] to release water for 45 days.

The Cauvery Management Authority, set up to **oversee**[8] the implementation of the 2018 verdict, has worked during normal monsoon years. But the Court did not **codify**[9] a formula for water-sharing in years when the rains **play truant**[10]. Its emphasis on **sustainable**[11] water use was **lost on**[12] the two states, and the dispute **flared up**[13] again in 2023 — the first **below-par**[14] monsoon after 2018.

The Tamil Nadu government has said that it will continue legal efforts to secure its share of the Cauvery's waters. Karnataka's push for the Mekedatu Dam on the river has **reignited**[15] old fears . The D K Shivakumar government's argument that the dam would primarily serve Bengaluru's water needs while allowing better regulation of releases hasn't **found any**

VOCABULARY 101

1	**Sluice gates**	(Noun phrase)	Water-control gates	जलद्वार / मोरी फाटक
2	**Contingent on**	(Adjective + preposition)	Dependent on	पर निर्भर
3	**Ascribed**	(Verb)	Attributed	कारण ठहराया
4	**Riparian**	(Adjective)	Riverbank-related	तटवर्ती / नदी-तटीय
5	**Ignited**	(Verb)	Triggered	भड़काया
6	**Impasse**	(Noun)	Deadlock	गतिरोध
7	**Leeway**	(Noun)	Flexibility	कार्य करने की स्वतंत्रता / ढील
8	**Oversee**	(Verb)	Supervise	निगरानी करना
9	**Codify**	(Verb)	Systematise	संहिताबद्ध करना / नियमों में ढालना
10	**Play truant**	(Idiom)	Stay absent	अनुपस्थित रहना / धोखा देना
11	**Sustainable**	(Adjective)	Maintainable	सतत / टिकाऊ
12	**Lost on**	(Phrasal adjective)	Unappreciated by	अनदेखा कर दिया गया / समझ न आना
13	**Flared up**	(Phrasal verb)	Erupted	अचानक भड़क उठा

takers[16] in Tamil Nadu. The fact is, the Cauvery today has to meet the **competing demands**[17] of agriculture and urbanisation. Therefore, rather than **lean on**[18] the judiciary, Cauvery-dependent states **would do well to**[19] come together and plan for the efficient use of the river's waters. Solutions ranging from **disincentivising**[20] water-intensive crops to encouraging **decentralised**[21] water management will require inputs of hydrologists, economists, agri-scientists and farmers' organisations. Representatives of the two states will need to sit together, understand each other's fears and **shed**[22] **confrontationist**[23] attitudes.

Source: **The Indian Express**

Published: **September 03, 2026 06:05 AM IST**

14 **Below-par** (Adjective phrase)
Below average • औसत से कम

15 **Reignited** (Verb)
Revived • पुनः भड़काया

16 **Found any takers** (Idiom)
Gained acceptance • स्वीकार करने वाले मिलना

17 **Competing demands** (Noun phrase)
Conflicting needs • परस्पर विरोधी माँगें

18 **Lean on** (Phrasal verb)
Depend upon • सहारा लेना / निर्भर होना

19 **Would do well to** (Idiom)
Ought to • अच्छा होगा कि ऐसा करें

20 **Disincentivising** (Verb (gerund))
Discouraging • हतोत्साहित करना

21 **Decentralised** (Adjective)
Locally managed • विकेंद्रीकृत

22 **Shed** (Verb)
Discard • त्यागना / छोड़ना

23 **Confrontationist** (Adjective)
Aggressive • टकरावादी / संघर्षशील

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact

THE INDIAN EXPRESS

INTER-STATE WATER DISPUTES & ENVIRONMENTAL GOVERNANCE

EDITORIAL STANCE

PERSUASIVE / ADVOCATIVE

"urging cooperative policy action"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author examines the recurring water-sharing dispute between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka during deficit monsoon seasons, pointing out that judicial decrees cannot substitute for institutional distress-sharing mechanisms. Highlighting the limitations of ad hoc legal battles, the editorial advocates for technical collaboration, crop diversification, and dialogue to balance agricultural and urban water requirements.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

10 WORDS

01	**Ascribed** VERB NEUTRAL	कारण ठहराया Regarded something as being caused by a specific factor or origin.	MEMORY HOOK A-SCRIBE means writing down a cause to explain an effect.	SYNONYMS • attributed • assigned • credited	ANTONYMS • disassociated • disconnected • severed
02	**Ignited** VERB NEGATIVE	भड़काया Provoked or sparked sudden and intense feelings, conflict, or controversy.	MEMORY HOOK IGNITE means lighting a match, metaphorically sparking an explosive dispute.	SYNONYMS • sparked • triggered • instigated	ANTONYMS • extinguished • quelled • dampened
03	**Leeway** NOUN POSITIVE	कार्य करने की स्वतंत्रता / ढील The amount of freedom to move or act that is available in a given situation.	MEMORY HOOK LEEWAY gives you 'way' or space to take action comfortably.	SYNONYMS • latitude • flexibility • discretion	ANTONYMS • constraint • restriction • rigidity
04	**Oversee** VERB NEUTRAL	निगरानी करना To supervise a person or an entire process to ensure correct execution.	MEMORY HOOK OVER-SEE: Seeing something from above to ensure it is done correctly.	SYNONYMS • supervise • monitor • scrutinise	ANTONYMS • neglect • ignore • overlook
05	**Codify** VERB NEUTRAL	संहिताबद्ध करना / नियमों में ढालना To arrange laws, rules, or guidelines into a systematic, official code.	MEMORY HOOK CODIFY = Arrange into a systematic CODE of laws.	SYNONYMS • systematise • formulate • standardise	ANTONYMS • disorganise • scramble • randomise

06	**Sustainable** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	**सतत / टिकाऊ** Able to be maintained at a certain rate or level without exhausting natural resources.	**MEMORY HOOK** SUSTAIN + ABLE = Able to be maintained long-term without depletion.	**SYNONYMS** • viable • enduring • renewable	**ANTONYMS** • unsustainable • depleting • short-lived
07	**Reignited** VERB NEGATIVE	**पुनः भड़काया** Revived or renewed feelings of anger, conflict, or controversy.	**MEMORY HOOK** RE (again) + IGNITE (spark fire); reviving an old conflict.	**SYNONYMS** • rekindled • reawakened • resuscitated	**ANTONYMS** • extinguished • pacified • suppressed
08	**Disincentivising** VERB (GERUND) NEUTRAL	**हतोत्साहित करना** Discouraging a particular action by removing advantages or imposing deterrents.	**MEMORY HOOK** DIS + INCENTIVE = Removing incentives to discourage unwanted behavior.	**SYNONYMS** • discouraging • deterring • dissuading	**ANTONYMS** • incentivising • encouraging • promoting
09	**Decentralised** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	**विकेंद्रीकृत** Controlled by several local offices or authorities rather than one single central authority.	**MEMORY HOOK** DE + CENTRAL = Moving power away from a single central authority to local units.	**SYNONYMS** • devolutionary • localised • dispersed	**ANTONYMS** • centralised • consolidated • concentrated
10	**Shed** VERB POSITIVE	**त्यागना / छोड़ना** To get rid of something no longer wanted, useful, or appropriate.	**MEMORY HOOK** Snakes shed their old skin; similarly, shedding old hostile attitudes.	**SYNONYMS** • discard • relinquish • abandon	**ANTONYMS** • retain • acquire • maintain

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · CAUVERY NEEDS A DISTRESS-SHARING COMPACT

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

3 TERMS

01	**Riparian** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	**तटवर्ती / नदी-तटीय** Relating to or situated on the banks of a river or natural body of water.	**MEMORY HOOK** RIPARIAN relates to RIVER; states located along a river's course.	**SYNONYMS** • riverside • riverbank • fluvial	**ANTONYMS** • inland • landlocked • arid
02	**Impasse** NOUN NEGATIVE	**गतिरोध** A situation in which no progress is possible, especially because of disagreement.	**MEMORY HOOK** IM-PASSE = Impossible to pass further due to complete disagreement.	**SYNONYMS** • deadlock • stalemate • standstill	**ANTONYMS** • breakthrough • resolution • headway
03	**Confrontationist** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	**टकराववादी / संघर्षशील** Tending to cause or engage in aggressive and hostile arguments or conflict.	**MEMORY HOOK** CONFRONT = Head-on clash; one who prefers hostile confrontation over talks.	**SYNONYMS** • belligerent • antagonistic • combative	**ANTONYMS** • conciliatory • peaceable • accommodating

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

1 TERMS

01	**Contingent on** ADJECTIVE + PREPOSITION NEUTRAL	**पर निर्भर** Dependent on or conditioned by future uncertain circumstances.	**MEMORY HOOK** CONTINGENT sounds like 'continual agent' whose action depends on another condition.	**SYNONYMS** • conditional upon • dependent on • subject to	**ANTONYMS** • independent of • unconditional • autonomous

PHRASAL VERBS

2 TERMS

01	**Flared up** PHRASAL VERB NEGATIVE	**अचानक भड़क उठा** Began suddenly or increased in violence or intensity.	**MEMORY HOOK** A flare suddenly bursts into bright fire; a dormant issue suddenly re-erupts.	**SYNONYMS** • erupted • reignited • resurged	**ANTONYMS** • subsided • abated • died down
02	**Lean on** PHRASAL VERB NEUTRAL	**सहारा लेना / निर्भर होना** To depend on someone or an institution heavily for help, support, or decisions.	**MEMORY HOOK** Physically leaning on a wall to stay upright, meaning depending on support.	**SYNONYMS** • rely upon • count on • depend upon	**ANTONYMS** • act independently • shun • disregard

IDIOMS & PHRASES

7 TERMS

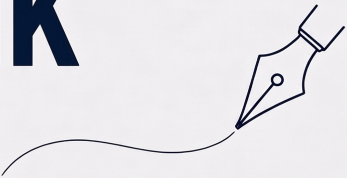
01	**Sluice gates** NOUN PHRASE NEUTRAL	जलद्वार / मोरी फाटक Sliding gates used for controlling the flow of water in a dam, reservoir, or canal.	**MEMORY HOOK** SLUICE sounds like 'SLIDE'; gates that slide up and down to regulate water flow.	**SYNONYMS** • floodgates • headgates • watergates	**ANTONYMS** • barriers • blockades • obstructions
02	**Play truant** IDIOM NEGATIVE	अनुपस्थित रहना / धोखा देना To stay away from where one is expected to be; used here to denote failure of rainfall.	**MEMORY HOOK** A truant child skips school without permission; here, rains fail to arrive.	**SYNONYMS** • be missing • default • fail to appear	**ANTONYMS** • show up • be present • arrive
03	**Lost on** PHRASAL ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनदेखा कर दिया गया / समझ न आना Failing to influence, impress, or be understood by someone.	**MEMORY HOOK** The message was LOST and never reached the recipient's understanding.	**SYNONYMS** • ignored by • unheeded by • unnoticed by	**ANTONYMS** • appreciated by • understood by • grasped by
04	**Below-par** ADJECTIVE PHRASE NEGATIVE	औसत से कम Below the usual, expected, or standard level or quality.	**MEMORY HOOK** In golf, 'par' is standard; 'below-par' performance or rainfall is worse than standard.	**SYNONYMS** • substandard • deficient • mediocre	**ANTONYMS** • above-par • exceptional • superior
05	**Found any takers** IDIOM NEGATIVE	स्वीकार करने वाले मिलना Found people willing to accept, purchase, or agree to an offer or argument.	**MEMORY HOOK** Nobody is willing to 'take' or buy into the proposal.	**SYNONYMS** • gained acceptance • found buyers • won support	**ANTONYMS** • faced rejection • met refusal • been dismissed
06	**Competing demands** NOUN PHRASE NEUTRAL	परस्पर विरोधी माँगें Multiple claims or requirements that cannot all be satisfied simultaneously.	**MEMORY HOOK** Two separate entities competing for the very same limited resource.	**SYNONYMS** • conflicting claims • rival interests • opposing needs	**ANTONYMS** • harmonious needs • aligned interests • mutual goals
07	**Would do well to** IDIOM POSITIVE	अच्छा होगा कि ऐसा करें Used to give advice or suggest that a course of action is sensible and beneficial.	**MEMORY HOOK** A polite phrase used by advisers meaning 'it is strongly recommended'.	**SYNONYMS** • ought to • should consider • are advised to	**ANTONYMS** • would regret • should avoid • are ill-advised to

TODAY'S
EDITORIALS

ONE STEP
AHEAD
EVERYDAY

SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

THANK YOU!



FOR READING. FOR LEARNING.
FOR GROWING EVERY DAY.

We're really thrilled to keep working on this. We hope you'll continue supporting this effort until the very end. Most importantly, we hope each one of you achieves success and gets selected in your recruitment exam. ❤️📚✨

If you put in the necessary effort and stay consistent, your ambition of building a career in the public or private sector can certainly become a reality.

> Just keep in mind one thing,
> ***"A reader lives a thousand lives before he dies...***
> ***The man who never reads lives only one."***

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Prathu

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Better Understanding

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